

PROJECT REPORT

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

PROJECT OBJECTIVE

Automate standard laptop procurement and configuration so that an approved request automatically generates a task for the Hardware team.

ServiceNow • Service Catalog • Flow Designer

DETAIL	VALUE
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Team ID	SWUID-2026359158
Technology	ServiceNow Service Catalog and Flow Designer
Date	15 February 2025

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DOCUMENT BASIS

The report follows the section order of the supplied Final Report Template and uses the project information from the supplied ServiceNow source document.

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Overview

The project “Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer” addresses inefficiencies in the IT procurement process for standard laptops. The source project identifies delays and manual overhead, particularly when a standard laptop request requires configuration after approval.

The proposed implementation uses ServiceNow Flow Designer to automatically create and assign a configuration task to the Hardware team after the relevant service request is approved. This connects the Service Catalog request, approval, Requested Item, automation flow, and Catalog Task into a repeatable workflow.

1.2 Purpose

The purpose is to provide a seamless and efficient process for standard laptop procurement and configuration. The project aims to reduce manual intervention and potential errors, improve resource utilisation within the IT department, reduce user waiting time, and enhance overall productivity.

USER STORY

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the Hardware team for configuration.

2. IDEATION PHASE

2.1 Problem Statement

The current IT procurement process lacks sufficient automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead when handling standard laptop orders. Standard laptop requests often require configuration, but this step can be overlooked or delayed. This creates frustration for users waiting for their devices and can result in inefficient allocation of IT resources.

2.2 Empathy Map Canvas

The source document does not contain a separate Empathy Map Canvas. The following points are therefore derived only from the documented user story and problem statement.

- Needs: timely laptop configuration, clear task ownership, and reduced manual follow-up.
- Pain points: delays, manual intervention, and risk of configuration tasks being overlooked.
- Desired outcome: a predictable workflow where approval automatically initiates the required hardware task.

2.3 Brainstorming

- Automate task creation after approval.
- Use the Service Catalog as the request interface.
- Use Flow Designer to connect approval and task creation.
- Automatically assign configuration work to the Hardware group.
- Maintain visibility through Request, Requested Item, Approval, and Catalog Task records.

3. REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS

3.1 Customer Journey Map

1. User opens ServiceNow and navigates to the Service Catalog.
2. User selects Hardware and the Standard Laptop catalog item.
3. User selects Order Now and submits the laptop request.
4. The request enters the approval process.
5. After approval, the configured Flow Designer flow is triggered.
6. A Catalog Task is automatically created with the required description and Hardware assignment.
7. The Hardware team receives the configuration task and proceeds with laptop configuration.

3.2 Solution Requirement

REQUIREMENT	DESCRIPTION
ServiceNow platform	ServiceNow instance with Service Catalog and Flow Designer access.
Catalog item	Standard Laptop configured under the Hardware category.
Flow	Flow named "Standard Laptop Task", configured to run as System User.
Trigger	Service Catalog trigger starts the workflow.
Action	ServiceNow Core – Create Catalog Task.
Task fields	Short description/description: "Laptop need to Configured"; Assignment group: Hardware; Approval: Approved.
Process Engine	Standard Laptop catalog item is linked to the Standard Laptop Task flow.

3.3 Data Flow Diagram

WORKFLOW

USER → SERVICE CATALOG → REQUEST → APPROVAL → FLOW DESIGNER → CREATE CATALOG TASK →
HARDWARE → LAPTOP CONFIGURATION

The Request and Requested Item records provide the workflow context. The Catalog Task record represents the configuration work created by the automation.

3.4 Technology Stack

COMPONENT	TECHNOLOGY / ROLE
Platform	ServiceNow
Request interface	Service Catalog
Workflow automation	Flow Designer
Core action	Create Catalog Task
Records	Request, Requested Item, Approval, Catalog Task
Assignment	Hardware group

4. PROJECT DESIGN

4.1 Problem Solution Fit

The solution directly addresses the documented problem of manual intervention and delays in standard laptop configuration. Connecting approval to automatic Catalog Task creation ensures that the Hardware team receives the configuration task promptly after approval.

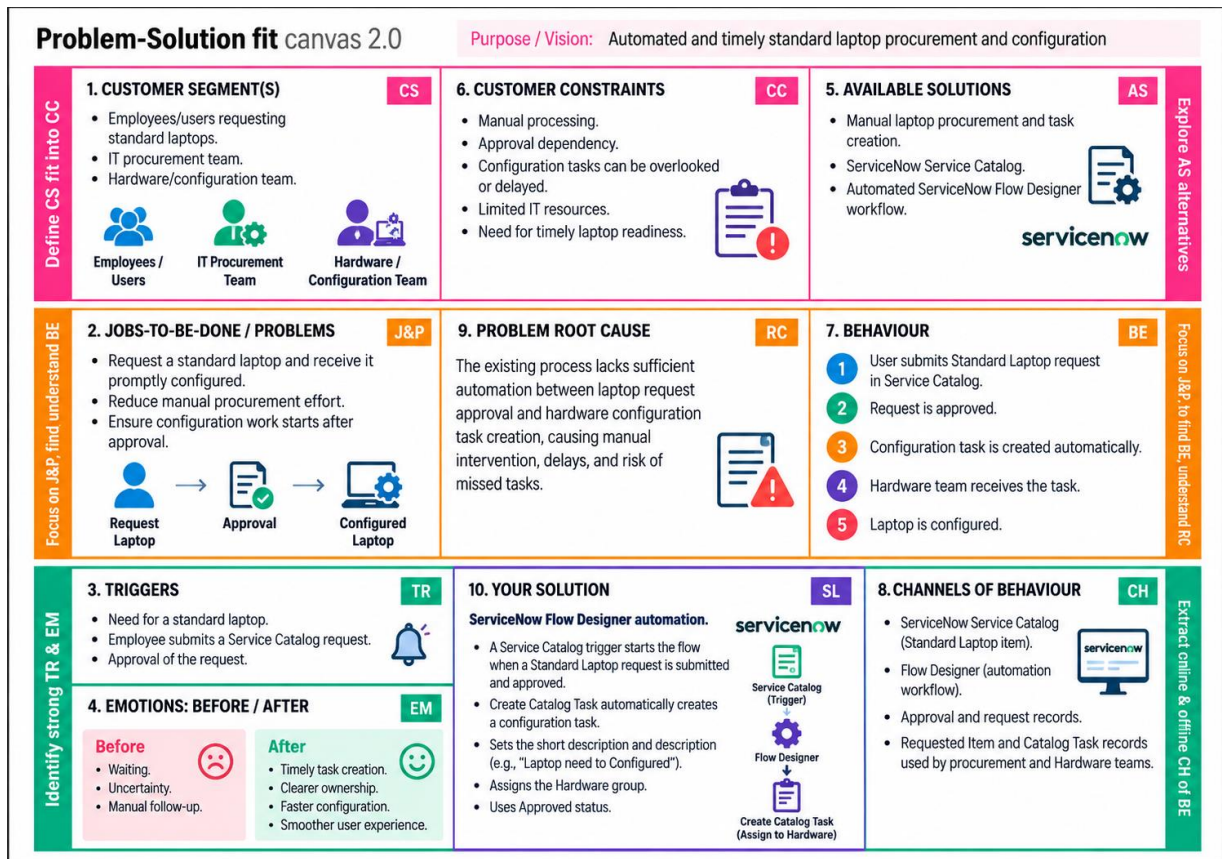


Figure 1: Problem–Solution Fit canvas for the Standard Laptop procurement automation project

4.2 Proposed Solution

A Standard Laptop request is submitted through the Service Catalog. Once the request is approved, the Service Catalog trigger starts the “Standard Laptop Task” flow. The flow uses Create Catalog Task, passes the Requested Item record into the task, sets the short description and description, assigns the task to Hardware, and records the approved state. The flow is then activated and assigned to the Standard Laptop catalog item.

4.3 Solution Architecture

- User layer: Employee/user submits the Standard Laptop request.
- Service layer: Service Catalog creates the request and Requested Item and handles approval.
- Automation layer: Flow Designer detects the Service Catalog event and executes Create Catalog Task.
- Execution layer: Hardware assignment group receives the generated Catalog Task and configures the laptop.

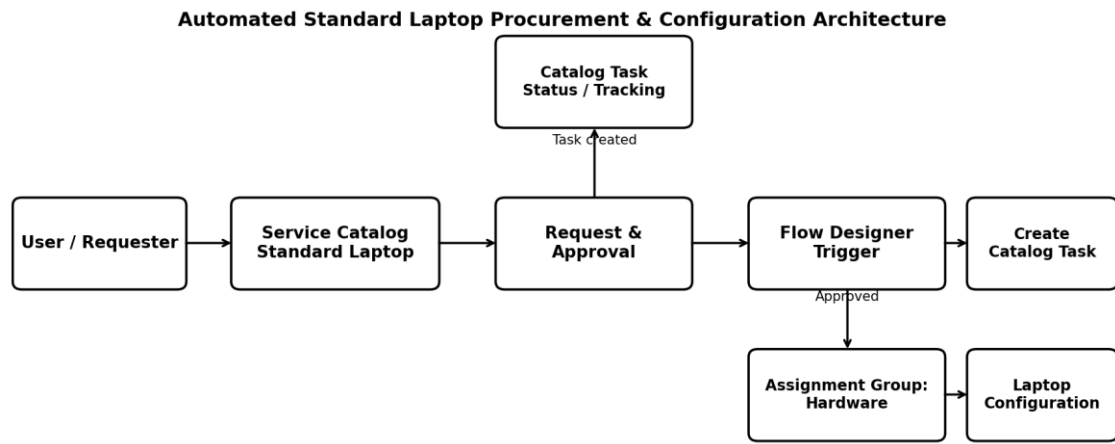


Figure 2: Solution architecture and workflow for Standard Laptop automation

5. PROJECT PLANNING & SCHEDULING

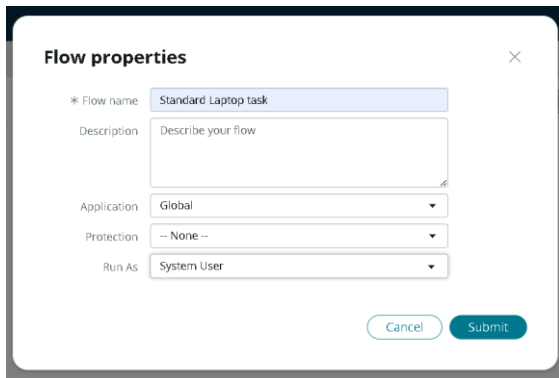
5.1 Project Planning

MILESTONE	ACTIVITY	OUTPUT
Milestone 1 – Flow	Create Standard Laptop Task; configure Service Catalog trigger and Create Catalog Task action.	Activated automation flow
Milestone 2 – Flow Assignment	Assign the flow to the Standard Laptop catalog item through Process Engine.	Catalog item linked to flow
Milestone 3 – Service Catalog	Submit request, monitor status, complete approval, and inspect Requested Item.	Configuration task generated
Final Validation	Verify task description, approval, and Hardware assignment.	End-to-end workflow validated

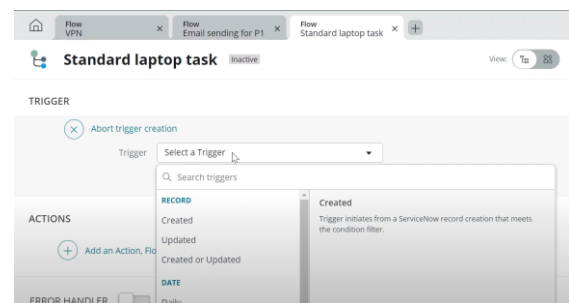
Implementation Sequence

8. Create the flow and configure its properties.
9. Add the Service Catalog trigger.
10. Add Create Catalog Task and populate task fields.
11. Save and activate the flow.
12. Assign the flow to the Standard Laptop catalog item.
13. Submit a Standard Laptop request.
14. Approve the request and verify the generated Catalog Task.

Implementation Evidence



Flow properties



Service Catalog trigger

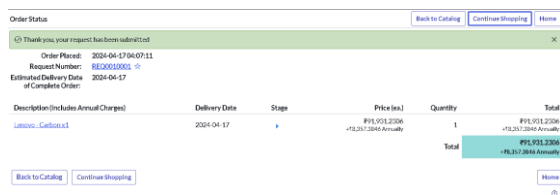
6. FUNCTIONAL AND PERFORMANCE TESTING

6.1 Performance Testing

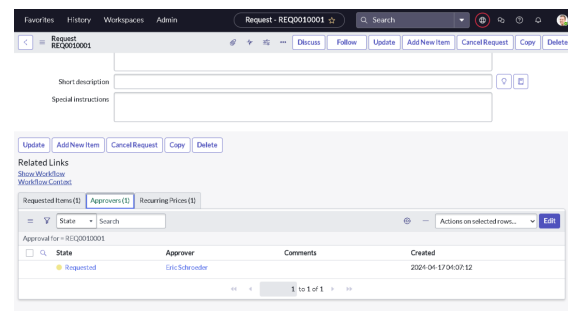
The source project focuses on workflow functionality and operational efficiency rather than providing numerical performance benchmarks. Testing therefore concentrates on verifying the end-to-end automation and correctness of the generated task.

TEST CASE	EXPECTED RESULT
Request creation	Standard Laptop request can be submitted.
Approval	Approval record is available and can be approved.
Trigger	Flow starts when the Service Catalog condition is met.
Task creation	Catalog Task is generated automatically.
Field validation	Short description, description, approval, and assignment group contain the configured values.
Assignment	Generated task is assigned to Hardware.

6.2 Test Execution Screens



Order Status / approval



Requested Item / task area

6.3 Result Validation

- Approval is completed on the request.
- Requested Item contains a Catalog Task.
- Catalog Task shows the configured short description and description.
- Assignment group is Hardware.

7. RESULTS

7.1 Output Screenshots

The source project demonstrates the resulting ServiceNow records after the Standard Laptop request is approved. The generated Catalog Task contains the configuration description and is assigned to the Hardware group.

The screenshot displays the 'Requested Item - RITM0010001' record. The top navigation bar includes 'Favorites', 'History', 'Workspaces', and 'Admin'. The record header shows 'Requested Item - RITM0010001' with a search bar and action buttons: 'Discuss', 'Follow', 'Update', and 'Delete'. Below the header, the 'Activities' section shows one activity by 'System Administrator' with field changes on '2024-04-17 04:07:10'. The 'Related Links' section includes 'Flow Context'. The 'Catalog Tasks (1)' tab is active, showing a table with one task.

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop needs to Configured	2024-04-17 04:11:40	(empty)	

Approval record / Requested Item

The screenshot displays the 'Request - REQ0010001' record. The top navigation bar includes 'Favorites', 'History', 'Workspaces', and 'Admin'. The record header shows 'Request - REQ0010001' with a search bar and action buttons: 'Discuss', 'Follow', 'Update', 'Add New Item', 'Cancel Request', 'Copy', and 'Delete'. Below the header, there are input fields for 'Short description' and 'Special instructions'. The 'Related Links' section includes 'Show Workflow' and 'Workflow Context'. The 'Requested Items (1)' tab is active, showing a table with one approver.

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12

Requested Item and Catalog Tasks

Standard Laptop task Active

View: 18 | Test De

1 now Create Catalog Task

Action: Create Catalog Task

Table Name: Catalog Task [sc_task]

* Requested Item [Requested Item]: Trigger - ... Requested Item ...

Short Description: Laptop needs to Configured

Fields:

- Description: Laptop needs to Configured
- Assignment group: Hardware
- Approval: Approved
- + Add field value

Wait: ☒

Template Catalog: Catalog Task [sc_task]

Create Catalog Task action

Catalog Item
Standard Laptop

Update Copy Try It Edit in Catalog Builder De

Name: Standard Laptop Application: Global

Catalogs: Service Catalog Active: ☒

Category: Hardware Fulfillment automation level: Unspecified

State: -- None --

Checked out: -- None --

Owner:

Item Details **Process Engine** Picture Pricing Portal Settings

Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog Item. Only one engine can be selected.

Flow: Standard Laptop task

Workflow:

Execution Plan:

Update Copy Try It Edit in Catalog Builder Delete

Standard Laptop Process Engine configuration

7.2 Project Outcome

RESULT

The workflow replaces manual task creation with an automated approval-to-Hardware-task process, supporting faster configuration and more consistent task ownership.

8. ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES

8.1 Advantages

- Reduces manual intervention in standard laptop procurement.
- Reduces the chance of configuration tasks being overlooked.
- Creates consistent task assignment to the Hardware group.
- Improves user waiting time and procurement workflow efficiency.
- Provides traceability through ServiceNow request and task records.

8.2 Disadvantages / Limitations

- The documented implementation is specifically focused on Standard Laptop requests.
- The source does not document integration with external procurement systems.
- The source does not provide quantitative performance measurements.
- The process still depends on the configured approval stage before the hardware task is generated.

9. CONCLUSION

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow Flow Designer, the project addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. The workflow ensures that laptop configuration work is initiated after approval, routes the task to the Hardware team, reduces user waiting time, and improves IT resource utilisation.

FINAL OUTCOME

A Standard Laptop request moves through Service Catalog and approval, then automatically produces a Hardware-assigned configuration task through Flow Designer.

10. FUTURE SCOPE

- Extend the workflow to additional hardware catalog items.
- Introduce conditional routing for different hardware types and departments.
- Add automated notifications for requesters, approvers, and Hardware staff.
- Add reporting and dashboards for approval time, task turnaround time, and workload.
- Integrate additional procurement and asset-management processes where required.
- Add escalation or SLA-based actions for delayed configuration tasks.

11. APPENDIX

11.1 Source Code

No standalone source-code file is provided in the source project document. The implementation is primarily a ServiceNow configuration using Flow Designer and Service Catalog.

11.2 Dataset Link

Not applicable. The source project is a ServiceNow workflow automation project and does not specify a dataset.

11.3 GitHub & Project Demo Link

No GitHub repository or external demo link is provided in the source project document.

11.4 Project Workflow Summary

STAGE	INPUT	AUTOMATION / ACTION	OUTPUT
1. Request	Standard Laptop selection	Service Catalog request	Request / Requested Item
2. Approval	Submitted request	Approval process	Approved request
3. Automation	Approved Requested Item	Flow Designer trigger	Flow execution
4. Task Creation	Requested Item	Create Catalog Task	Configuration task
5. Assignment	Catalog Task	Assign to Hardware	Hardware-owned task
6. Configuration	Hardware task	Laptop configuration	Configured laptop